



Side Menu Bar

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Learning Outcomes

At the end of the lesson, the students should be able to:

1. Explain the purpose and function of a side menu bar.
2. Identify the common contents of a side menu bar in websites and applications.
3. Differentiate the types of side menu bars.
4. Apply basic UI/UX principles in designing a side menu bar.
5. Create a simple side menu bar using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript.

What is a Side Menu Bar?

- A side menu bar is a navigation panel placed on the left or right side of a website or application.
- It contains links, buttons, or icons that allow users to move between different sections or pages.
- It is commonly used in:
 - Dashboards
 - E-commerce websites
 - Mobile applications
 - Admin systems

➤ Learning management systems ➤ Inventory systems

Purpose of a Side Menu Bar

- The main purpose of a side menu bar is to help users navigate easily.
- It allows users to quickly access important pages or features without searching around the interface.
- A good side menu bar helps users answer the question:

➤ “Where can I go next?”

- It makes the system easier to use and understand.

Importance of Navigation

- Navigation is important because it guides users while using a website or application.
- If the navigation is clear, users can complete tasks faster.
- If the navigation is confusing, users may feel lost or frustrated.
- In UI/UX design, good navigation improves:

- Usability completion ➤
- User satisfaction Accessibility
- Task
- Overall user experience

Side Menu Bar in Web Design

- In web design, the side menu bar is often used to organize multiple pages or sections.
- For example, an admin dashboard may have pages for:
 - Dashboard
 - Users



Products



Orders



Reports



Settings

- Instead of placing all links at the top, a side menu provides more space and better organization.

Side Menu Bar in Mobile Applications

- In mobile applications, a side menu is often called a drawer menu.

- It is usually hidden and appears when the user taps the menu icon.
- The menu icon is often represented by three horizontal lines, also called a hamburger icon.
- A mobile side menu saves space and keeps the screen clean.

Example of Side Menu Usage

- A side menu bar can be used in different systems.

- Examples:
 - **E-commerce app:**
 - Home
 - Categories
 - Cart
 - My Orders
 - Profile

Example of Side Menu

Usage • Examples:

- **Admin system:**

- Dashboard
- User Management
- Product Management
- Reports
- Settings

Example of Side Menu

Usage • Examples:

- **School portal:**

- Home

- Grades

- Schedule

- Enrollment

- Announcements

Top Navigation vs Side Menu Bar

Top Navigation	Menu placed at the top of the page	Simple websites with fewer pages
Side Menu Bar	Menu placed on the side of the page	Systems with many pages or features

- Top navigation is useful for simple websites.
- Side menu navigation is useful for dashboards, e-commerce systems, and applications with many sections.

Common Contents of a Side Menu Bar

- A side menu bar may
 - Profile or account
 - contain: ➤ Logo or
 - application name ➤ Home link
 - Orders or purchases
 - Notifications ➤ Settings
 - Categories
 - Help or support ➤ Logout

button

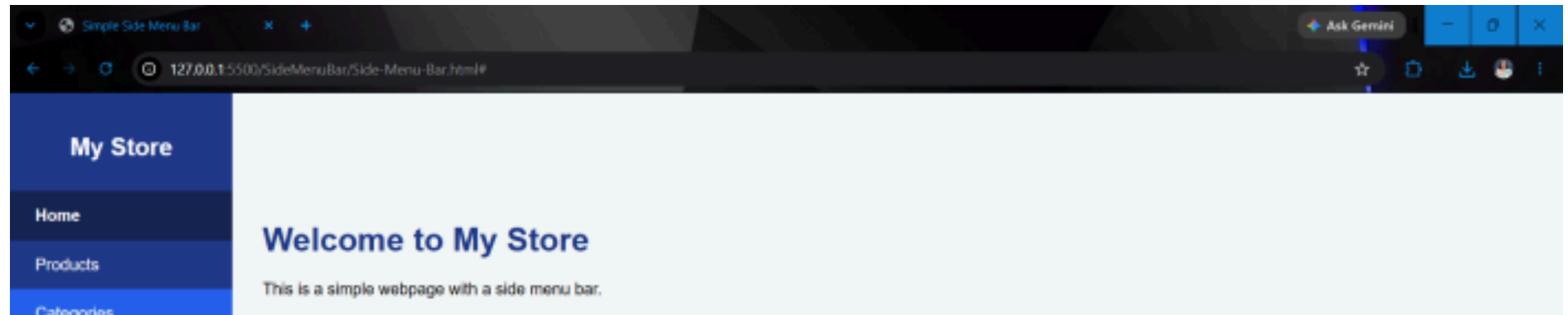
Side Menu Bar in E-Commerce

- In an e-commerce website, the side menu bar helps users browse and shop more easily.

- It can organize product categories, account options, orders, cart, wishlist, and customer support.
- A good side menu improves the shopping experience by reducing confusion and helping users move around the website quickly.

Sample E-Commerce Side Menu

Structure



Example

side menu

structure:

Types of Side Menu Bars

- There are different types of side menu bars:
 - Fixed side menu
 - Collapsible side menu
 - Slide-out drawer menu
 - Icon-only side menu
 - Responsive side menu
- Each type is used depending on the design and screen size.

UI/UX Principles in Side Menu Design

- A good side menu bar

should follow basic UI/UX principles:

- Clear labels

- Consistent icons

- Proper spacing

- Organized grouping

- Readable text ➤ Visible

- active page ➤ Easy access

- Responsive layout

Proper Grouping of Menu Items

- Menu items should be grouped based on their purpose.
 - Categories
- Example:
 - Products
- Main Navigation ▪ User Activities
 - Home
 - Cart

➤ Wishlist

Profile

Logout

➤ My Orders

➤ Settings ➤

▪ **Account** ➤

Active Menu Indicator

- An active menu indicator shows the current page the user is

viewing.

- Example:

- If the user is on the Cart page, the Cart menu item should be highlighted.
- This helps users know where they are inside the website or application.